what can be done. The poor and the planet, both need help. India is moving ahead on this with not just a positive attitude but also a mindset to drive solutions. Our initiative of 'One World, One Sun, One Grid' was one such positive initiative.

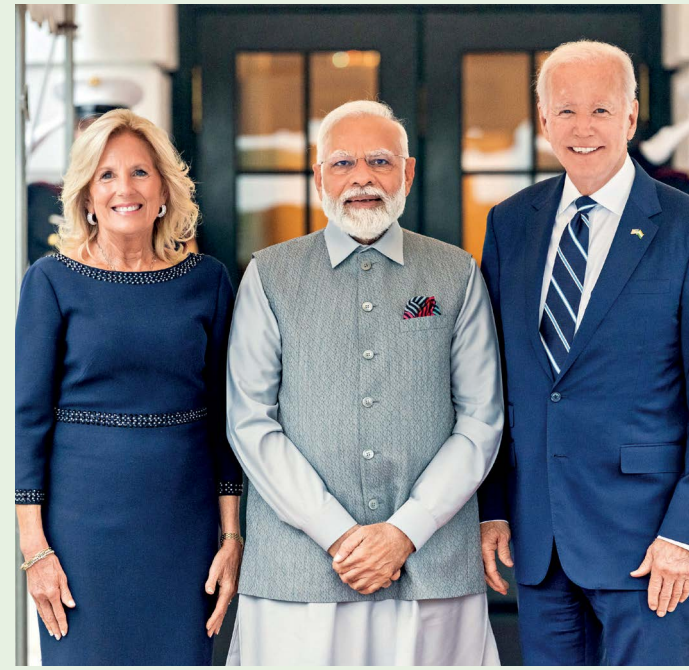
There is a need to be action-oriented in thinking. If there is no transfer of technology and no adequate funds, how can poor countries work on climate change mitigation? Our presidency prioritises resource-mobilisation for climate finance, and tailoring support for transitions to individual country needs. Acknowledging the need for innovative green technologies, we emphasise financial solutions, policies and incentives to spur private investment in the development and deployment of low-carbon solutions.

India advocates for a diverse global policy palette on transition, allowing countries to select from various pricing and non-pricing strategies, from carbon taxes to green technology standards, based on their unique situations. Our experience has been that true transformation comes only from mass movements, from people's participation. Our Mission LiFE seeks to make the fight against climate change a mass movement by focusing on lifestyle transformation. When every individual feels they can directly make a difference to the planet's welfare, the results will be much more broad-based.

Q. There are important financial issues that are part of India's G20 agenda, including debt restructuring for countries facing high levels of sovereign debt. How hopeful are you of a consensus on these issues?

Financial discipline is very important for all countries. It is the duty of each country to guard itself against financial indiscipline, but at the same time there are forces that have sought to take undue advantage by catalysing a debt crisis. These forces have capitalised on the helplessness of other countries and led them into debt traps. The G20 has prioritised addressing the debt vulnerabilities in low- and middle-income countries since 2021. Achieving the 2030 SDG (sustainable development goals) agenda depends on progress in these countries, yet debt servicing hinders their efforts, limiting fiscal space for SDG investments.

In 2023, under India's presidency, the G20 gave a significant boost to debt restructuring through the Common Framework. Before India's lead, only Chad had undergone debt restructuring under this framework. With India's focus, Zambia, Ethiopia and Ghana have made notable advancements. India, being a key creditor, played a pivotal role here. Outside the Common Framework, G20 forums also facilitated the debt restructuring coordination for Sri Lanka, with a committee co-chaired by India, Japan and France. We also saw the inception of the Global Sovereign Debt Roundtable, co-chaired by the IMF, World Bank and the G20 presidency.



"THE G20 GROUP IS SEEN AS A RAY OF HOPE GLOBALLY, AND THE GROUND FOR THIS WAS LAID DURING INDIA'S PRESIDENCY. THE WORK DONE AND THE OUTCOMES EXPECTED ARE ALL FUTURISTIC IN NATURE"

Q. India has taken up the important agenda of reforming the multilateral development bank (MDB) structure. But previous efforts haven't had much impact....

The G20's efforts on MDB, till recently, have focused on how balance-sheets can be optimised so that they can use their existing resources most effectively. However, since the pandemic, there has been a realisation that MDBs need to integrate global challenges within the core development mandate. This would need reform in the existing frameworks of functions of MDBs and expansion of their existing financial resources. During our presidency, we have been able to effectively steer this issue. Unlike earlier, the call for reforms of the MDBs is now coming from the shareholders themselves and this has ensured a lot more traction for the issue. The presidency also established the 'G20 Independent Expert Group on Strengthening MDBs'. This group comprises some of the best global minds on international financial architecture. It has already submitted Volume 1 of its report, and will present the second one in October. The recommendations largely echo India's thoughts on enhancing the financial strength of MDBs, increasing the lending levels to meet the core mandates of eliminating poverty and fostering shared prosperity.

Photographs by ANI